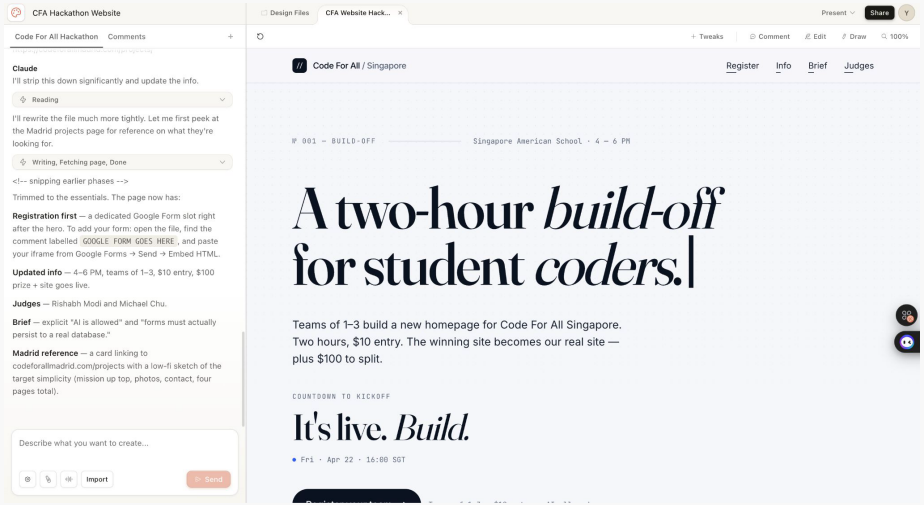
LaunchLab: Claude Design, Claude Code, GitHub, and Vercel

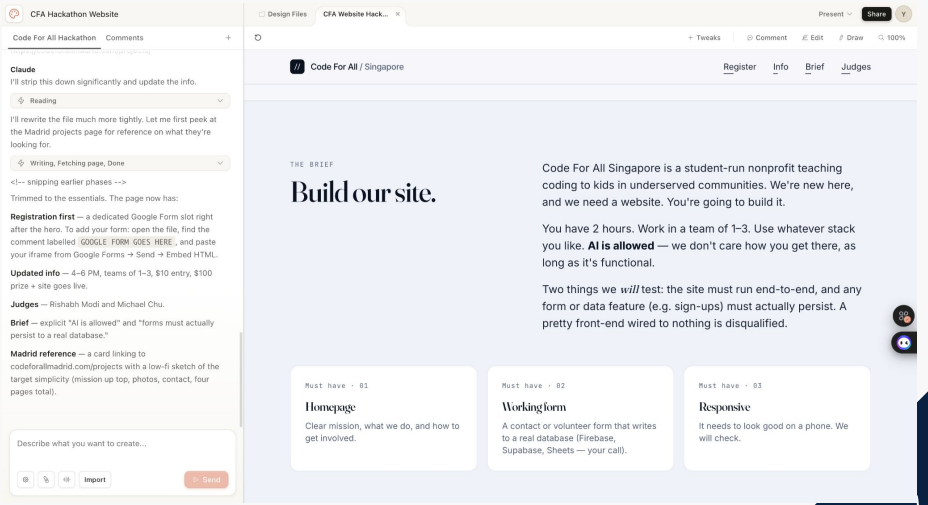
Who We Are



Part 1

Design Your Front End First





- Claude Design allows you to build the visual shell of your site
- Describe how you want it to look without any code!

The Art of Prompting

Bad prompting:

- “Create a website for my course
- “Create a modern website for my coding course with a homepage and lessons.”



The Art of Prompting

Role: You are an expert educational web designer and full-stack developer.

Goal: Create a responsive website for a 15-lesson course called **"Vibe Coding: Build Apps with Lovable & GitHub."**

Target audience: High-school and early-college students with little to no coding experience.

Core pages required:

1. Landing page (course overview + value proposition)
2. Curriculum page (15 lessons with goals and agendas)
3. Lesson page template (objectives, agenda, exercises)
4. About page (instructor + course philosophy)
5. Resources page (GitHub links, tools, templates)

Design style:

1. Modern, playful, and approachable

2. Light background, bold headings

3. Friendly typography (not corporate)

Output required:

4. Folder structure

5. Core page code

6. Reusable lesson template

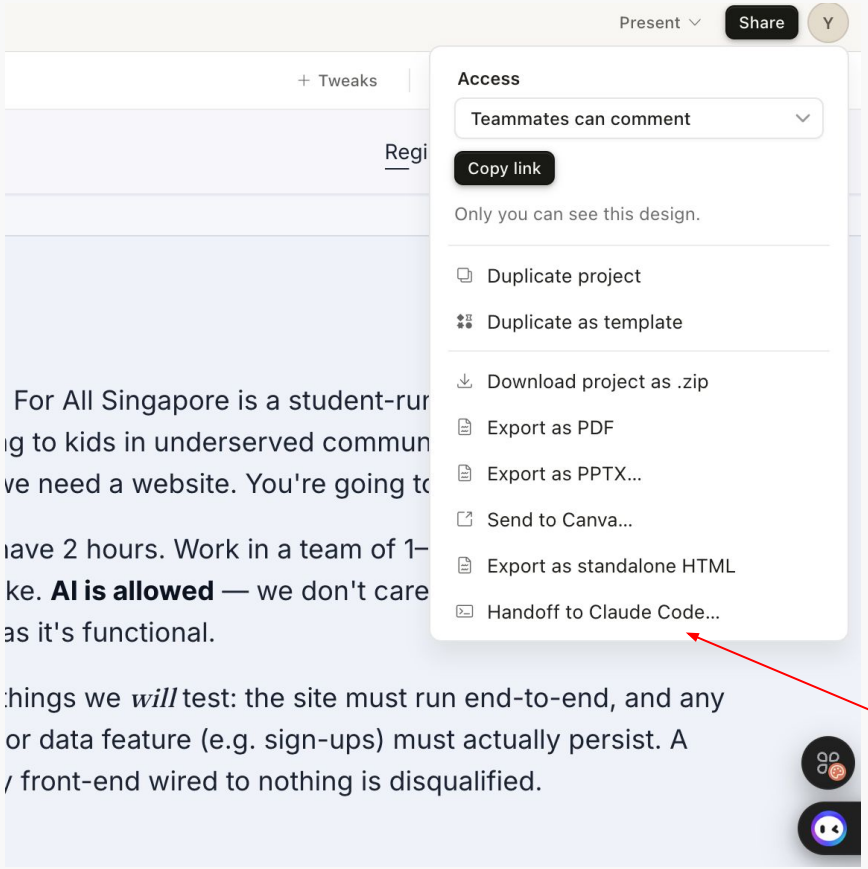
7. Brief explanation of design decisions

8. Build the site so it can be easily expanded with more lessons later.

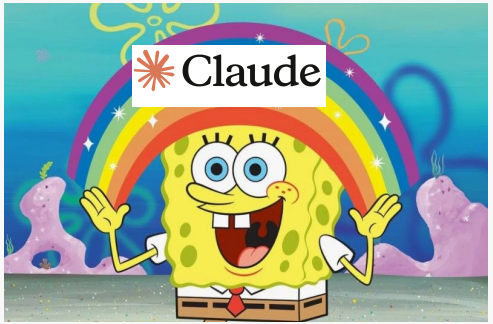
Key features:

1. Clean, student-friendly UI
2. Clear call-to-action buttons (Enroll / Start Lesson)
3. Mobile-first design
4. Easy navigation between lessons

Export Your Design



- When your design is done, open the **Share** menu in the top right
- Find **"Handoff to Claude Code..."** in the export options — this is the bridge that connects the two tools
- It sends your finished design straight into Claude Code, which turns it into a real, working site
- Locate this button *before* you start building — you'll need it, and it's easy to miss in the menu



What is Claude Code?

Agentic Coding System

Claude Code is an agentic, terminal-based coding system. It goes beyond simple autocompletion by reading entire codebases, executing system shell commands, running pipelines, and proactively debugging failures.

For Product Designers

Democratizing engineering workflows. Builders can specify features in high-level prose to rapidly prototype, build functional microservices, and deploy complete interactive experiences without auditing code manually.



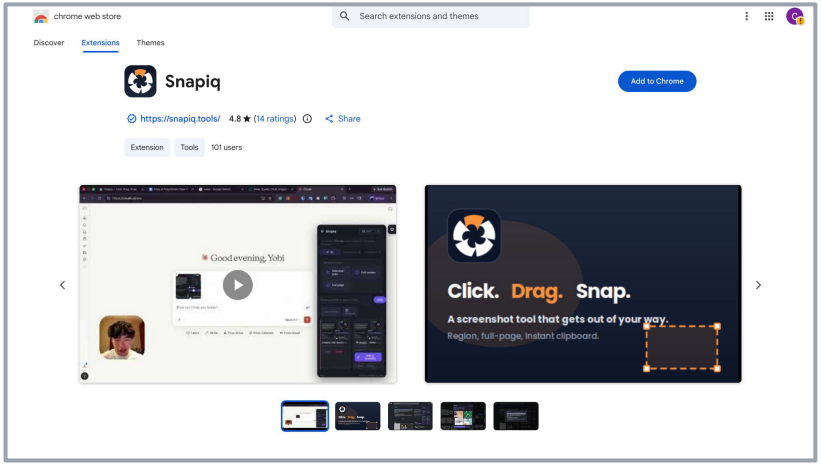


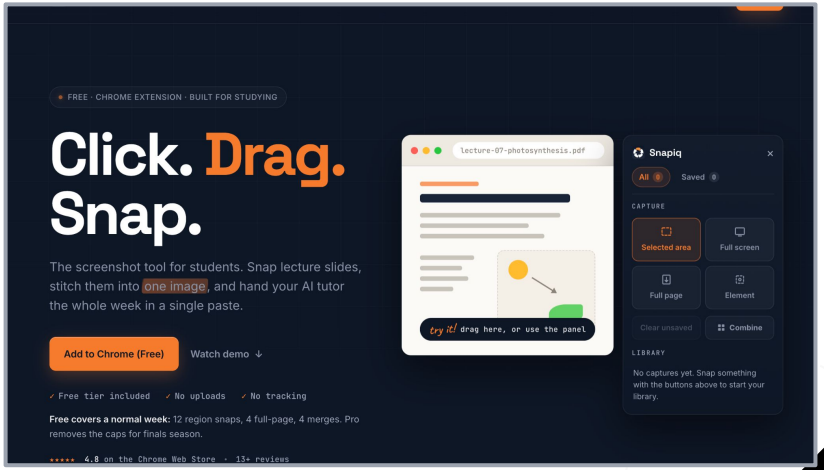


What Can You Build?

Apps, chrome extensions, websites, trading algorithms, etc.

Example: Snapiq chrome extension





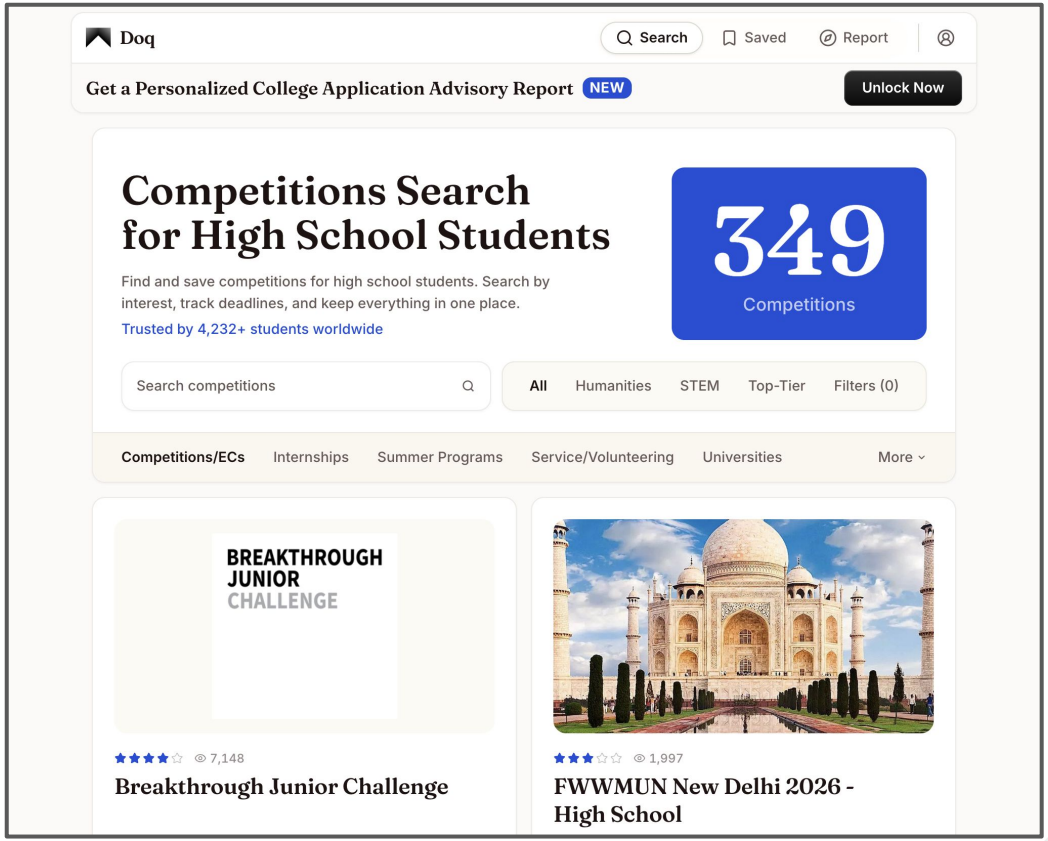
https://snapiq.tools/

What Can You Build?

Doq.world:

Competition finder for high school students

https://doq.world/



What It Can Do

Routines

Set automated background loops, schedule daily test checks, or configure customized multi-stage file tasks that operate directly inside the local sandboxed environment.

- "Check this folder for errors every hour."
- "Run a multi-step process: clean the files, test the code, then generate a report."
- **Key idea:** Claude Code can handle repeated background workflows inside your local project environment.

Refactoring

Seamlessly rename variables, update file layouts, and change package versions globally. Claude handles complex directory structures and maintains absolute syntax integrity.

- "Rename this variable everywhere it appears."
- "Make this code easier to read while keeping the same functionality."
- **Key idea:** Claude Code can help clean up or reorganize existing code without changing what the code actually does.

Session Context

Maintain continuous context memory trees across terminal cycles. Enables quick rollbacks, instant code explanations, and natural-language pipeline query states.

- **Key Idea:** Claude Code can keep track of
  - What commands were run.
  - What errors happened earlier.
  - What files were changed.
  - What you were trying to fix.

Part 1 Summary: The Whole Workflow

1. Design

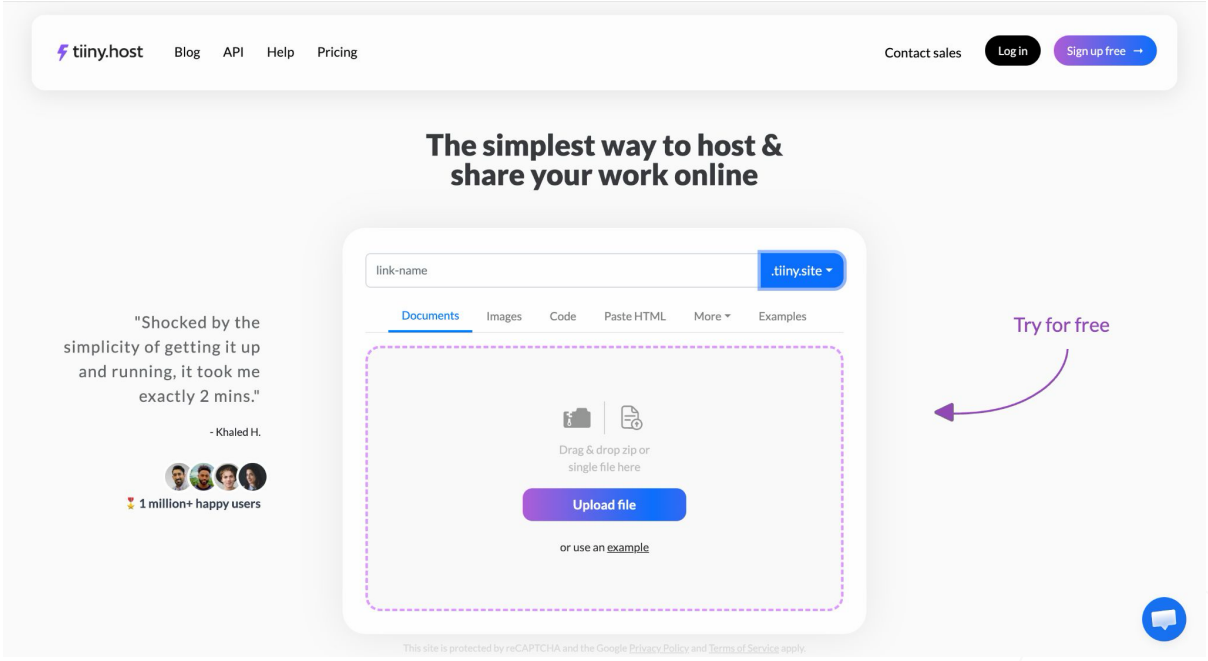
Use Claude Design to make your website look like how you want it to without any code.

2. Build

Use Claude Code to build the actual file by handing off the design you made in Claude Design.

3. Deploy

Use localhost or tiiny.host to launch your final website!



If using tiiny.host, put this prompt into Claude Code once you are done:

"Put all my website files into one folder and zip it, with index.html at the top level, so I can upload it to tiiny.host."

Part 2

What is GitHub

1. Store

Keep all your project files and their history in one location. This place is called the repository.

2. Share

Make your work accessible. You can make it public so that anyone can see, use, and learn from what you have created.

3. Collaborate

Work with your friends or coworkers without overwriting each other's codebase.



Key Terms

1. Grab an existing project

Fork: Make your own copy of someone else's repo on your GitHub account, so you can change it without affecting the original.

Clone: Copy a repo from GitHub down onto your computer so you can edit the files locally.

2. Save and upload your work

Commit: Save a snapshot of your current changes, along with a short note describing what you did. This will save locally and NOT on GitHub.

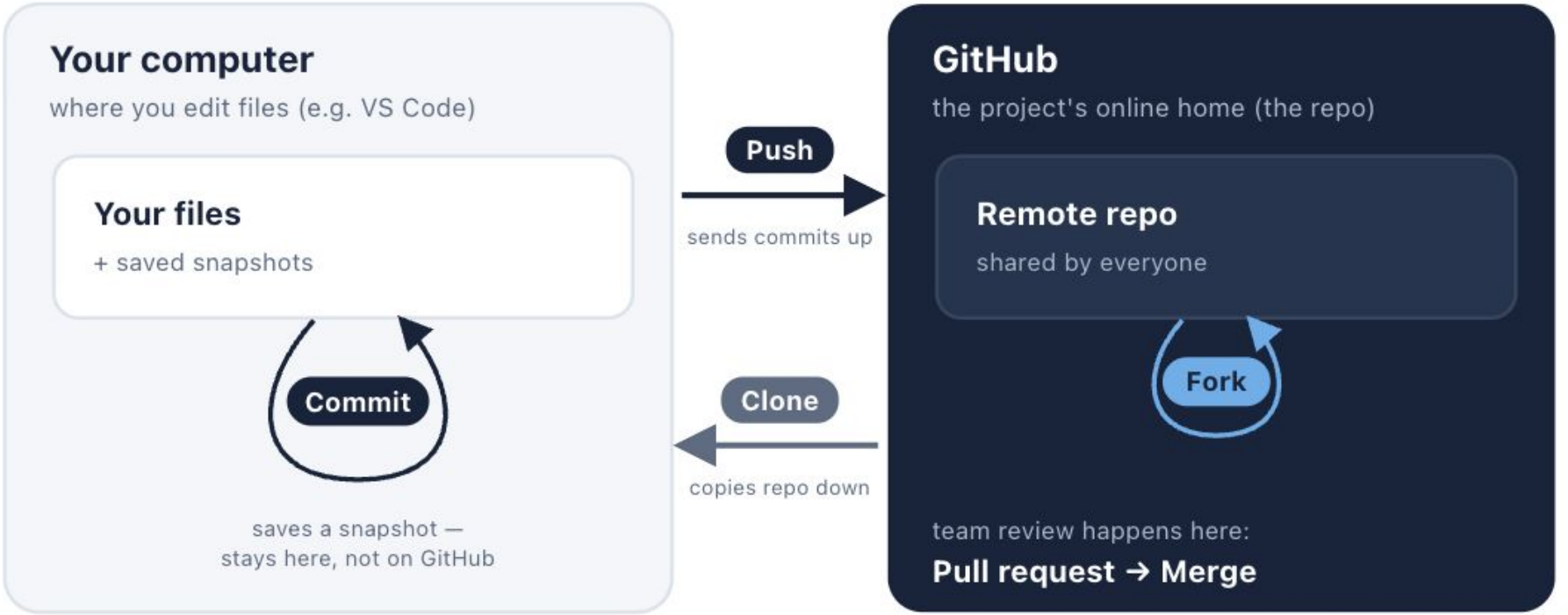
Push: Send the commits you saved on your computer up to GitHub, so the online copy is up to date.

3. Combine work with a team

Pull Request (PR): Propose your changes and ask teammates to review them before they get added to the main project.

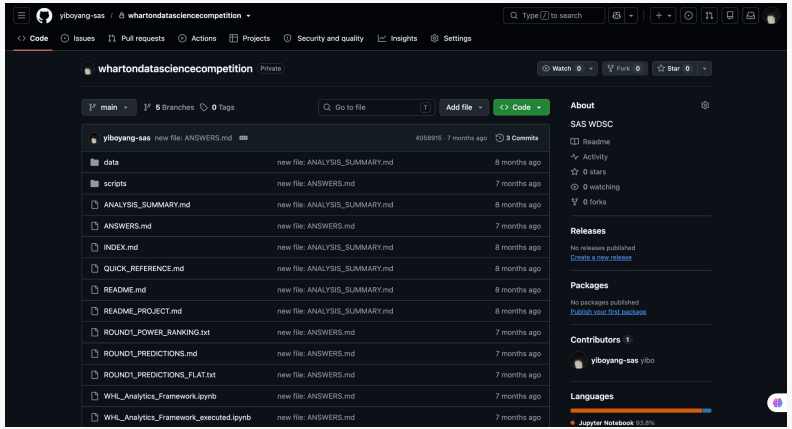
Merge: Approve the changes from a pull request and combine them into the main version of the project.

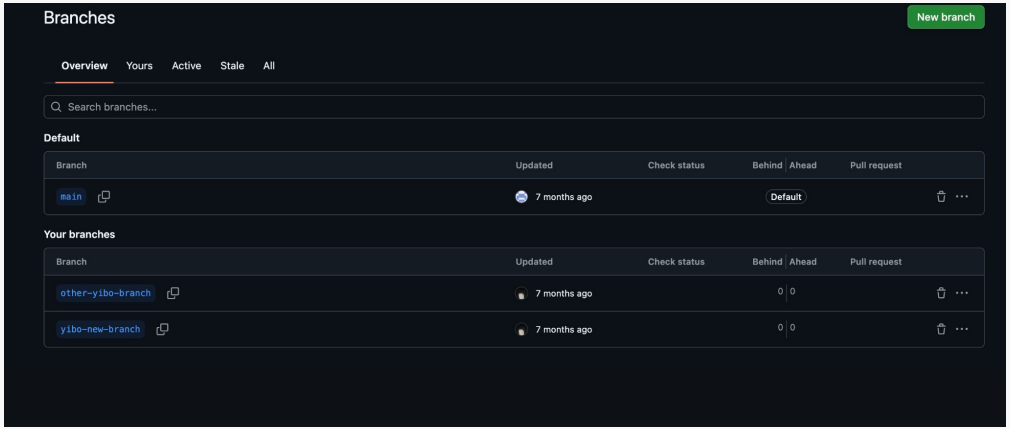
How It Works



Most Git actions just move your work between these two copies.

How a Repository Looks





Push vs Pull Request

⬆️ Push

Direct Action:
Uploads your commits straight to repo - no waiting, no approval.

No Review:
Changes go live immediately on whatever branch you push to.

Use When:
Working solo or on your own branch and you're confident in your changes.

🔀 Pull Request

Request for Review:
Propose your changes and asks teammates to look before anything is merged.

Discussion:
Others can comment, suggest edits, and approve or reject the changes.

Use When:
Working on a team or contributing to someone else's project.

Intro to Vercel

This is similar to tiiny.host!



1. Connect

Link your GitHub repo to Vercel once. From then on, Vercel watches that repo for you.

2. Deploy

Every time you push, Vercel grabs the new code and updates your live site in seconds. No manual uploading, ever.

3. Preview

Every pull request gets its own preview link, so your team can see the changes before merging them.

What's the difference between GitHub and Vercel?

GitHub stores your code: every file, every version, shared with your team. But nothing there is a website yet.

Vercel turns that code into one. It reads your repo, builds the site, and hosts it at a public link that updates every time you push.

Step 1: Get Your Code Into GitHub

1. Make A Repo

Sign in to github.com → click the green **New repository** button. Name it, keep it **Public**, click **Create**.

2. Let Claude Code Push It

Copy your new repo's URL, then paste the prompt on the right into Claude Code. It runs the git commands for you.

3. Check It Worked

Refresh your repo page. Your files should be there - that's your first **commit** and **push**.

Type This Into Claude Code

> "Push this project to Github. Initialise a git repo, commit everything with a clear message, and push it to **<paste your repo URL>**."

If it asks you to sign in to GitHub, follow its instructions in the terminal.

Using Lovable Instead?

You don't need any of this. Open your project - **Settings** - **GitHub** - **Connect**. Lovable creates the repo, pushes your code automatically, and keeps it in sync from then on. Skip to Step 2.



Step 2: Connect To Vercel

1. Sign In With Github

Go to **vercel.com** and sign up using your **GitHub account**. This is what lets Vercel see your repos.

2. Import Your Repo

On your dashboard, click **New Project** → **Import Git Repository** → pick the repo you pushed in Step 1. Authorize Vercel when GitHub asks.

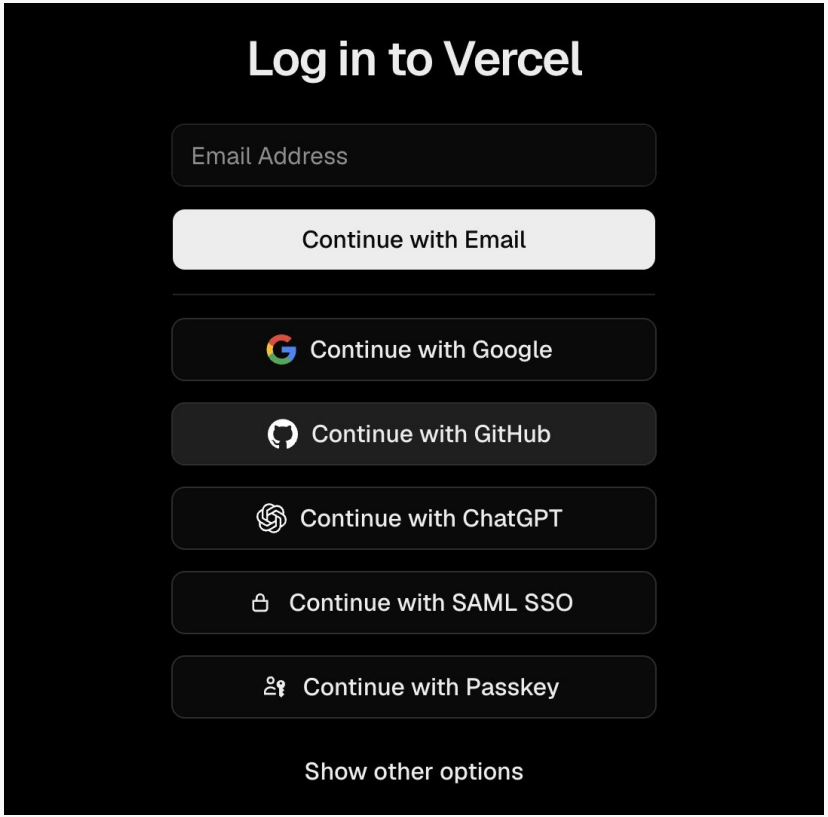
3. Deploy

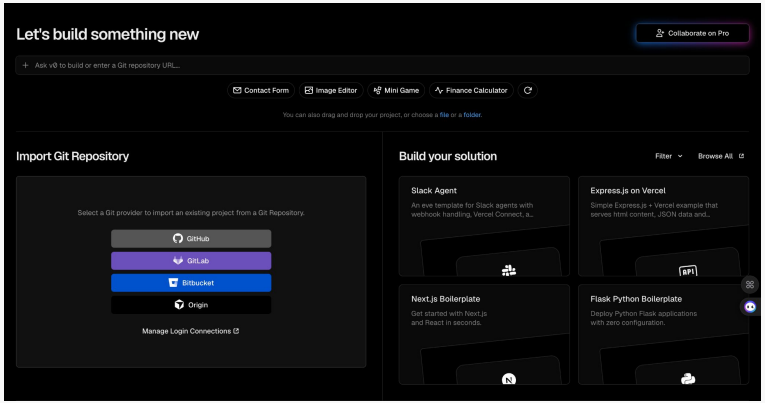
Vercel auto-detects your setup. Click **Deploy**, wait a few seconds, and you get a **live public link**.

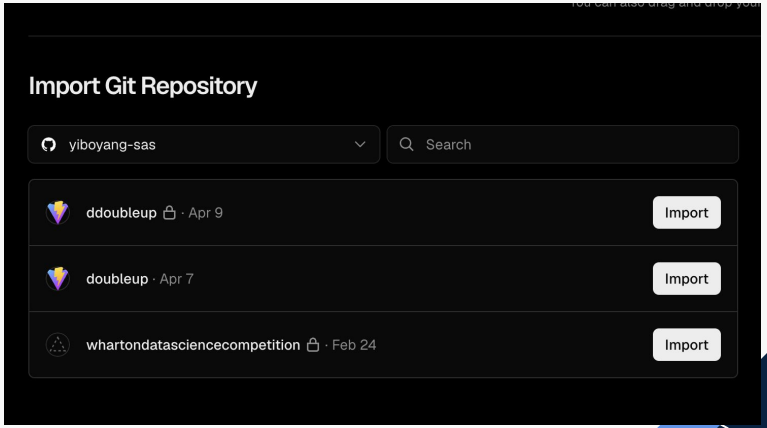
From now on, you never upload anything again.

Every time you push to GitHub, Vercel rebuilds and updates your live site automatically. And every pull request gets its own preview link, so your team can see changes before merging.

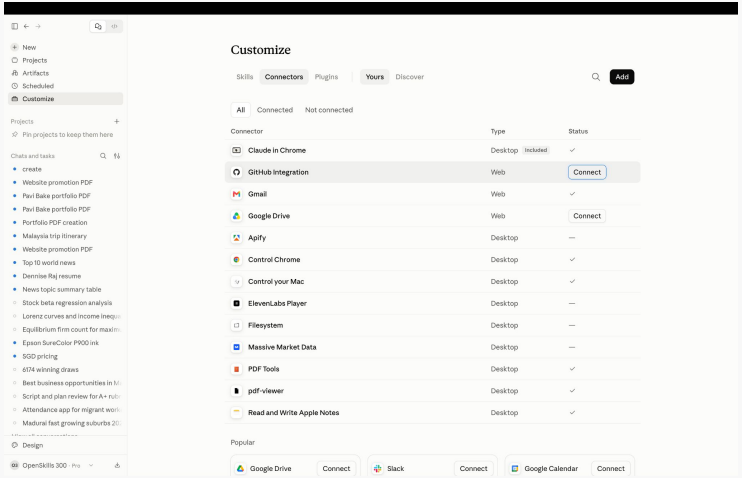
GitHub → Vercel

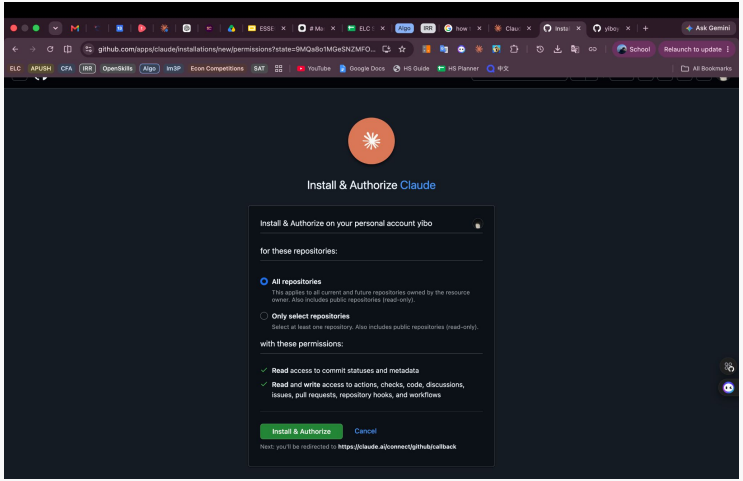


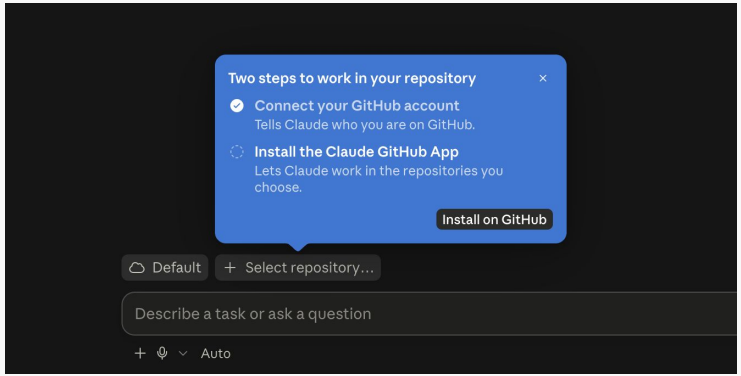


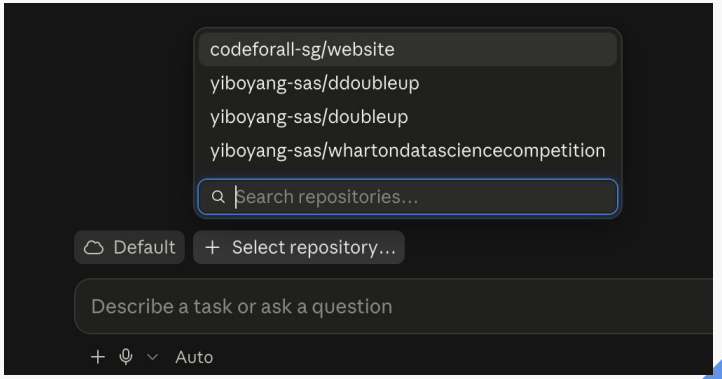


Claude → GitHub









Some File Types To Remember

index.html

The words, structure, every heading, button and paragraph people actually read.

styles.css

The look: colours, fonts, spacing, and how it changes on a phone versus a laptop.

script.js

The behaviour: what happens when somebody clicks, types, or hits submit.

Who can tell me

1. Which file do you open to change the text on your main button?
2. Which file do you open to make that button orange?
3. Which file do you open to make it do something when clicked?

Part 3

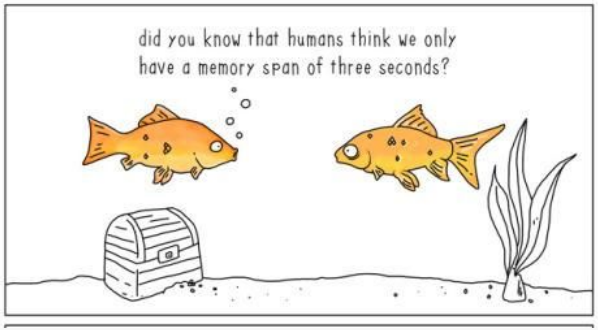
Two Things Your Site Still Can’t Do

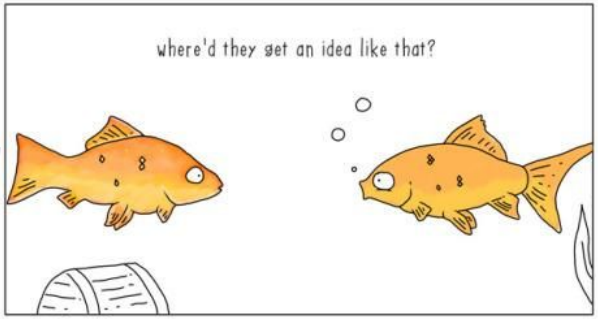
1. It Forgets Everyone

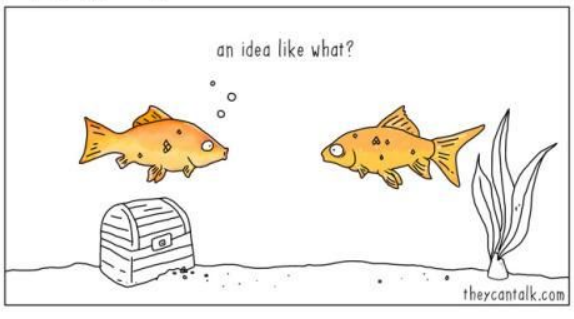
For example, if you were to create a clone of Wordle, when you close the tab, it has no idea who you were. It can’t keep track of users or saved games

2. It Knows Only Its Own Files

It can’t tell you anything that is live. This could be the weather, temperature, etc. It can only display what you typed in the original code.







How Logging In Works

Sign Up

When someone signs up on a website or app, it creates a new row in the user table. This table includes your email and a scrambled version of your password.

Log In

When you try to log in, it verifies if your email and password match what is registered in the user table. If they match, it will hand your browser a token.

Log Out

Logging out throws your token away. This means the site stops recognizing you until you log in again.

What A Token Is

A token is a temporary sticker that says “this is James”. Your browser shows it on every request, so the site doesn’t ask for your password on every single click. It expires on its own.

Notice What All 3 Actions Are

Your site is sending a request to another computer and getting an answer back. Logging in is just an API call!

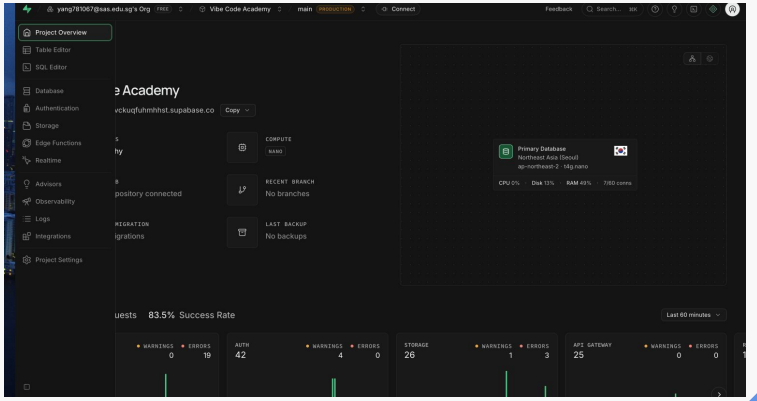
Supabase

Supabase

Supabase is an open-source backend-as-a-service (BaaS) platform that allows you to create authentication, verification, and a database system for your users. It's heavily connected to GitHub, Vercel, and an automatic installation to Lovable.

supabase

It also allows you to see your statistics



Task

Create a website that will contain a tab from each guest speaker session this semester. Each tab can be an interactive game to consolidate what you learned in that session. Use the tools we talked about today to do it!

